'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Spring 2021

CMA Pool Update

by Susan Betts, (O-6) Secretary/2021 Pool Liaison

We have begun preparations for opening the CMA Pool on May 29th, the Saturday of Memorial Day weekend. As the COVID-19 pandemic is ongoing, we will continue many of the same practices we put in place last year. These practices will help ensure the safety of CMA members , guests, and pool staff. The final pool rules are still in the works. Tentative plans include:

- Continuing the expanded pool hours from last year, with two-hour reservation blocks:
  Sunday through Thursday - 11am – 5pm
  Friday and Saturday - 11am – 7pm.
- Continuing the reservation system to limit the number of persons at the pool at one time. We are working out the details of a reservation system and will provide additional information in the coming weeks.
- Increasing the number of roped-off "areas" to 5, thus increasing the number of people allowed at one time from last year. We will also have a small area for singles.
- Hot tub may be used in 15-minute increments during your two-hour time slot.
- No pool furniture will be provided. Please bring your own chairs.
- No inflatable rafts, pool noodles, or inner tubes.
- The CMA bathhouse and bathrooms will be closed.



We will continue to follow guidelines from local health officials and the CDC to determine the safest procedures to have in place, while still allowing us to enjoy the CMA pool. Stay tuned for additional information through the CMA Google Group over the next several weeks.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	May 15, 10:00 am	Teleconference
Community Pool Opens	May 29, 11:00 am	See Google Group for details
Board of Directors Meeting	June 12, 10:00 am	Teleconference
CMA Committee Meetings	July 2021	Date/Time set by Committee
Board of Directors Meeting	August 14, 10:00 am	Teleconference

Grin and Bear It!

Things got a bit wild after a heavy snowstorm at Iris Melton's house (K-12, The Growlery)!







Apparently, Terry and Marsha Moore's (P-9) bird feeder is <u>not</u> "secured by ADT."



Midnight snack at the Holzes (F-1, Logged Inn)

and another thing...



Rich Croce (D-5) spotted this Eastern Newt on the road. Did you know they can live for 12 to 15 years?

Freebies for Owners!
Tom Holz (F-1) has several of his carpenter bee traps available for owners - limit of two per lot, please. Contact Tom at 703-627-9391 or tlholz@me.com.

US 522 Berkeley Springs Bypass Project Update

by Eric Lienhard, (G-5)

The West Virginia Department of Transportation, Division of Highways (WVDOH) is on schedule to begin construction of the US 522 Bypass through Morgan County this summer.



Photo: Google Maps

The Berkeley Spring Bypass project is part of the US 522 project that consists of a four-lane roadway on a new alignment from the Virginia/West Virginia state line to the Maryland state line for approximately 19 miles. The overall project is broken into seven sections, based on anticipated construction durations and available funding assumptions. The first of these projects is known as the "Berkeley Springs Bypass".

In October 2020, a $59.82 million contract was awarded to Trumbull Corporation out of Pennsylvania to build the four-lane US 522 bypass around Berkeley Springs. The Bypass will begin just south of Berkeley Springs to a new interchange with WV 9. The project also includes three bridges and three intersections.

Current traffic studies state that 13,400 vehicles a day utilize US 522, with 30 percent of this use by trucks. The bypass along with future projects is expected to ease traffic congestion through downtown Berkeley Springs.

Highways officials are still in the process of purchasing property and obtaining rights of way for the project. In the meantime, the contractor will be relocating utilities through the fall to accommodate the new Bypass.

The project is scheduled for completion in 2023.

Owner Suggestion: Community-Wide Waste Collection

by Dawne Holz, (F-1) Treasurer

During the March 13 Community Session (via Zoom), owners asked the Board to look into contracted waste collection for the community. Currently, 47 owners contract individually with Apple Valley Waste for once a week waste collection from their "animal resistant" bin. Collection is on Tuesday mornings; unless a holiday delays it by one day.

Standard waste removal will not be feasible for CMA as it would require all residents to use a waste toter (a large bin on wheels). Toters would need to be wheeled out to the road the morning of collection and stored in a secure spot (not animal resistant). This would create a number of issues:

1. Most homes do not have a garage to secure the toter away from animals.
2. Part-time residents may not be in residence on collection days and toters cannot sit at the road for days before/after collection.
3. Many homes are on gravel or steep driveways - difficult to move a toter to/from the main road.

We also considered one large, central dumpster, or several smaller, strategically positioned dumpsters throughout the community. Concerns were:

1. Doesn't alleviate animal access issues.
2. Creates an attractive system for non-residents to dispose of waste which could lead to drop offs of unsightly waste or large items.
3. Residents may not want to haul their trash to a central location - preferring to use their waste bin near their home.

We are working with Apple Valley Waste to find a solution for waste collection from our existing bins. If we can reach a cost-effective agreement, the Board will consider contracting for community-wide waste collection. Stay tuned! More to come!

The Board appreciates owner suggestions for ways to improve our community and services provided. If you have suggestions, you can send them to the Board at coolfont.board@gmail.com.

New Water & Sewer Rates

Effective June 1, 2021

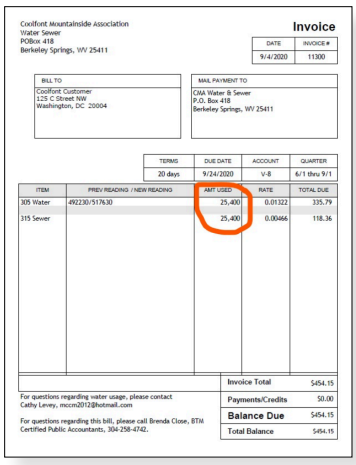
Last month, the West Virginia Public Service Commission issued new rate tariffs for CMA Water & Sewer. The new rates will take effect on **June 1, 2021** and be reflected in the September 2021 bills.

New Rates

- Minimum usage amounts will increase from 500 gallons to 4,500 gallons.
- Water rates are increasing from $13.21 per 1,000 gallons to $25.62 per 1,000 gallons.
- The minimum charge for water will now be $115.29.
- Sewer rates are increasing from $4.66 per 1,000 gallons to $7.60 per 1,000 gallons.
- The minimum charge for sewer will now be $34.20.
- Leak adjustment rates will change to $2.25 per 1,000 gallons for water and $0.59 per 1,000 gallons for sewer.

Estimating Your Bill

Owners can get an estimate of their future bills by looking at their past water and sewer invoices. Using the number of gallons in the "AMT USED" column on the invoice, multiply by $0.02562 for water and $0.00760 for sewer. Owners using less than 4,500 gallons per quarter will be charged the minimum charge for water ($115.29) and sewer ($34.20).



Coolfont Mountainside Association
Water Sewer
POBox 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Invoice

DATE	INVOICE #
9/4/2020	11300

BILL TO
Coolfont Customer
125 C Street NW
Washington, DC 20004

MAIL PAYMENT TO
CMA Water & Sewer
P.O. Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

TERMS	DUE DATE	ACCOUNT	QUARTER
20 days	9/24/2020	V-8	6/1 thru 9/1

ITEM	PREV READING / NEW READING	AMT USED	RATE	TOTAL DUE
305 Water	492230/517630	25,400	0.01322	335.79
315 Sewer		25,400	0.00466	118.36

Invoice Total	$454.15
Payments/Credits	$0.00
Balance Due	$454.15
Total Balance	$454.15

For questions regarding water usage, please contact Cathy Levey, mccm2012@hotmail.com

For questions regarding this bill, please call Brenda Close, BTM Certified Public Accountants, 304-258-4742.

Invoices emailed to owners in early September will reflect the new rates. Payment is due within 20 days of the invoice date, after which late fees of 10% will apply. Payments can be made online using the link in the invoice email.

Copies of the current and new tariffs and the Delinquent Water & Sewer Policy are available on the Coolfont website in the Owners section, under Documents.

Know Your Neighbors

[We like to include information about our interesting and diverse community residents. Send your photo and short story to coolfont.news@gmail.com.]

Jack Wennersten, (Q-9)



Jack Wennersten lives with his wife, Ruth Ellen, in Coolfont and on Capital Hill in Washington, DC. He is an Emeritus History professor at the University of Maryland, Eastern Shore. He has held Fulbright Professorships at the National University of Singapore and the University of Hong Kong. Additionally, he was a founding professor at the School of International Studies at Tokiwa University in Mito, Japan. He is the author of 10 books, all of which are in print. His new book, ***Strange Fruit, Racism and Community Life in the Chesapeake*** will be released this summer. His wife, two children, and their families love Coolfont.



Rudolph Tree?

Whatever you call it, it's one of the amazing natural formations in our community. Try and spot it on your next walk around Mountainside Road. (Hint: Eric L. and Heidi S. own the porch in the background.) Photo: Rich Croce (D-5)

Spring on the Mountainside!













Clockwise from upper right: Red Buds, Joanie Zuckerman (T-4); Yellow Trillium, Ramps, Snow Drops, Dutchman's Breeches, Blood Root, Craig Deane, (T-3).

Ramps, ramsons, or wild leeks, are one of the earliest wild edibles to emerge, and, for some, they're the holy grail of wild edibles. A type of wild onion with a unique garlicky-onion flavor, most folks either love them or despise them.

From the Archives

The Daily Mail - Hagerstown, Maryland
July 20, 1972 (edited for space only)

'Coolfont' Embraces the Arts in a Real 'Strawhat' Setting

By Libbie Powell



The sun rises, casting its shadow on the manor house at "Coolfont." It is in the manor house that musical offerings take place during the summer, and in the barn (not seen), theatre is taking place each weekend.

Back around 1912, Herbert Quick, a writer, decided to seek a place "away from it all" where he could commune with nature, and enjoy living, and continue his writing.

The spot he selected to build a fine manor house was at the foot of the Cacapon Mountain, beyond Berkeley Springs, with a veritable forest of trees all around him, where he lived in the beauty and quietness of his surroundings.

Time passed, and Mr. and Mrs. S.F. Ashleman, Jr. came to Berkeley Springs, with the same thought in mind, settling in a mountainous area, in a spot filled with quietude and beauty. They also had in mind a spot to build a vacation resort with activities for families who desire to get back to nature.

It was through the suggestion of the late Mrs. Johnie Harmison of the Park View Inn, that the Ashelman's first found the Manor House and surrounding mountainous area known as "Coolfont" named by Herbert Quick for the cold gushing spring that runs by the manor house.

"Strawhat" Theatre

Each year something new has been added to the setting. There is a mountain lake, good for both swimming and fishing; there are furnished wooden chalets and log cabins, for family vacation fun; there is a camping area, tennis courts, riding stables, and place for a sauna, and a real, old fashioned barn, where "strawhat theatre" is now being held every weekend.

There has always been some sort of entertainment during the summer, including puppet shows for children, classical music performances by a string quartette at the manor house, and artists in residence. But this summer, there is the "Theatre-Go-Round," depicting West Virginia Folk Tales, by actors and musicians from the Creative Arts Center at West Virginia University.

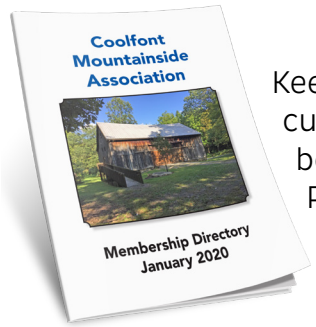
A Real Barn

Saturday evening found quite a collection of summer vacationers and people from the area assembled in the large barn that has been refurbished with lighting and chairs, and the genuine odor of hay, for both dramatic offerings and square dancing. Five-eighth baskets serve as light shades, for a very clever effect, and chairs are arranged semi-circle, before a specially built eye-level stage.

The entertainment in the barn is the earthiest, and began with "The Wreck of the C&O" complete with music, first in a march by all the troupe, then in complement, with a guitar and banjo background. The children in the audience were invited to come sit at the edge of the stage, and they were entranced by what was going on just one half foot away.

Another tall tale was "How Mosquitoes Were Made" which proved that they were but a shoot-off from a burning monster that inhabited the area; while the tale of John O'Hara, and his shadow, and their encounter with the devil was interesting, indeed. I understand another offering was cut short because of the sudden thunderous sound of a rainstorm falling on the barn's tin roof.

Directory Updates



Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We will also update the PDF available on the CMA website.

A-1 Michael DuBois
michaelddubois@comcast.net (303) 829-1482
Amy Gray DuBois
akgray66@gmail.com (540) 533-2721
Part Time Residents

Please remember to watch the Google Group for updates about plans and reservation processes for the pool for this year.

Board Shorts

February - No Board Meeting

March 13 Board Meeting (via Teleconference)

- Approved minutes from January 9, 2021 CMA and W&S Meetings
- Approved contract for grading and graveling Bluebird Lane
- Approved contract for ditch and culvert cleaning
- Approved write off of CMA "loans" to CMAWS as funds are noncollectable.

April - No Board Meeting

Front and Back cover photos: Dawne Holz (F-1)

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2021 MEMBER

Questions or comments for the CMA Board of Directors? You can now contact the Board via email at coolfont.board@gmail.com.

Water Issues?

Warm Springs Public Service District

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number, and the nature of the problem.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors
coolfont.board@gmail.com
Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website
www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

Google Group Email
cma-members@googlegroups.com

Google Group Signup/Web
groups.google.com/g/cma-members

Facebook
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Almost Heaven Property Mgmt
Holly Malcomb cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-671-0882

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!